

One limitation of performing analytics on anonymously submitted data is that the dataset may not represent the full population of graduate school applicants. People choose whether or not to submit their results, which creates self-selection bias. Applicants with strong profiles or positive outcomes may be more likely to share their results, while applicants with weaker profiles or unsuccessful outcomes may choose not to post. In addition, many records contain missing information such as GPA and GRE scores. Because submissions are anonymous, it is also difficult to verify whether all information is accurate. As a result, any statistics calculated from the dataset should be interpreted carefully and may not reflect the true characteristics of all applicants.

Some of the analysis results were interesting and somewhat surprising. One example was the relatively high acceptance rate for Artificial Intelligence master's programs (79.75%). This does not necessarily mean that admission is easy; rather, successful applicants may be more likely to share their outcomes online. Another interesting example was the average GRE Verbal score of 161.14, which is noticeably higher than national averages reported for graduate school test takers. This may be explained by selection bias as well, since highly competitive applicants are more likely to participate in online communities such as GradCafe and share their admissions results. Another observation was the average GRE score of approximately 261. At first glance, this value appears unusually low when compared with the current GRE scoring scale, where the combined Verbal and Quantitative score ranges from 260 to 340. However, the dataset may contain scores reported under different GRE scoring systems used over time. These examples show that analytics based on anonymous submissions can reveal useful trends, but the results should be interpreted with caution because the underlying data may be incomplete, biased, or inconsistent.